

Chemical Engineering Meeting

March 12th, 2018

Attendees: Vikas Berry, Alan Zdunek, Ludwig Nitsche, Sanjay Behura, Yijin Kang, Said Al-Hallaj, Lew Wedgewood, Michael Caracotsios, Betul Bilgin, Shafigh Mehraeen, and Gang Cheng

Minutes from 12/8/17:

- COE unanimous vote to recommend Chaplin for Tenure vote this summer
- Pg. 2 DFT
- Building safety → Doors open at 7 a.m. for students
- Minutes pass

Research Proposals:

- FY18 (Q1 & Q2)
 - # of Proposals = 22
 - Funds proposed \$77 Million
 - Awarded \$313K
- FY 17
 - # of Proposals = 29
 - Funds proposed \$10.2 Million
 - Awarded \$520K
- DOD now has funds and is accepting proposals

Undergrad Admissions:

Spring 2018

- ITE=26

Fall 2018:

- Applications at 241 from 222
- Admits at 142 down from 150
- ITEs 18 up from 17
- Fall 2017: 76 new students (+31%)

No building updates, aside from it is moving slowly.

ChemE Car:

2 Cars, both going to Purdue University on 4/6/18 in the AIChE Regional Conference

Chair position:

- Shriram Ramanathan 3/20/18
 - Age index of 50

- Materials, Experimental, 1,000sq. ft. lab
- Asked Dean Nelson for \$2 million Startup for Ramanathan
- 25% CME & maybe shared with Argonne National Lab to strengthen ties
- Never studied or worked in chemical, most of his papers are co-authored (mainly colleagues and Argonne collaborations)
- Mass & energy balance, thermodynamics, electrochemistry, solid fuel
- What would be the department collaborations? How could he enhance the department? Would he work with the department grad students and hire them on?
- Cell sensor, carbon capture, fuel cell (reactor)
- Ask who he could collaborate with inside the department
- His expenditures are \$3 million
- Dean's space in the new building would be his
- Argonne could provide lab space immediately
- Are we his first choice?
 - Does he prefer us to CME? He is looking at other positions in the city
 - He wants to work in chemical.
- Electrochemistry work
- Dean wants the 25% CME appointment

Staff position:

- 2 have been interviewed
- 3rd candidate interview on 3/14/18
- Karen will be in the department on Fridays until full time hire
- One of the candidates has undergraduate coordinating experience and has worked at UIC. Only one with this type of experience

222:

- Computer room, Monitors, Chairs and Computers are NOT to be Removed
- Room 230 has chairs that don't belong there and should be returned to 222 after use
- **230** the projector has been left on over the weekend, please make sure to turn projectors off and remind students to do so as well
- Students complain about lack of clocks in classrooms during exams, and it is a hassle to constantly keep the computer on or writing updates on the board

Grad Student issue:

- Complained about summer salary
- Faculty have promised students summer salary then backed out at the last moment
- If you have the funds give them at least 2 months
- Said offered a CPT internship at his company
- Policy for hire: Check funding before promising position
- 50 PhD full time and 17 TA, the rest are working in chemistry
- Need a model to at least hire RA 1-2 years may mean we need to reduce # of PhD

Course Schedule:

- 327 & 311 switched between Wedgewood and Liu for Fall 2018
- Clinical professor cannot teach 500 level course
- 494 Engineering & Entrepreneurship I Fall 2018 (new program)
 - Teach, Expand, Present
 - Level II: college level Present & Commercialize
- Need workshop for faculty to commercialize ideas

DUGS:

- Advising next week 3/19-3/23
- 13 accepted, congratulation emails have gone out, tapping into the undecided accepted students
- Trying to recruit from Women in Engineering (6 scholarships given out ranging from \$5k-\$30K)
- ChemE Forum 4/20/18: 1st Award ceremony, Safety Workshop, Training, Alumni Mixer
- Have curriculum meeting regarding 200 & 300 level courses
- 205 being taught to go through more slowly & teaching less in course; need a larger space
 - Need computers for every student for the course, either in a classroom or laptop rental.
 - Perhaps take an hour from 210 to add to 205 to cover enough material on computer slowly and thoroughly
 - 3 to 4 hours for 205? Take the hour from 396
- 321 taught in both semesters to help transfers (about ½ our students are transfers)

China Program:

- Only 2 students but it is college wide
- Parents don't want to send their kids to the USA right now
 - "Chain migration" F-1 to J-1 → H1B all reduced
 - 30-40% drop at college and nationwide drop

COE:

- Last year was a massive outlier, so normal by comparison should be compared to the previous year
- Increase at CS for undergrad massive influx

DGS:

- 40-50 MS application, 50 PhD applications
- Mainly PhD admits, Converting some PhDs to masters
- Masters: a lot of students applying for assistantship (but rare to receive it) should try providing masters admits data that shows they can receive it from other departments
- MS pay out of state plus differentials at about \$15,000